



Dave and Mary James' home near Rosetta sparkles with Christmas spirit. Their decorations were featured on a Maclean Hunter television show in December.

Drinking and then driving is just not an option

If you drink, then drive, you're a bloody idiot!

This slogan can be found on bumper stickers circulated throughout Victoria, Australia in conjunction with a major anti-drinking driving campaign. It is accompanied by a series of dramatic, high impact television commercials that graphically portray the consequences of drinking after drinking.

All of this leads one to ask the question - do educational programs make a difference? Especially among repeat offenders, does intervention in the form of education and increases in awareness translate

OPP Report

By Const. Neil Fennell



into improved attitudes around the issue of impaired driving. Although conclusive evidence of a link between educational programs and repeat offenders has yet to be clearly established a recent study by the Addiction Research Foundation did produce evidence of a link between educational programs and mortality rates.

Two groups of people convicted of impaired driving for a second time were compared. One group participated in an educational program while the other did not. The study suggests education is most beneficial to episodic drinkers in terms of reducing mortality risk from accidents and other violent acts, but may have limited impact on those

who have a well established pattern of chronic heavy alcohol consumption. Clearly education, even early intervention, is not the only answer. Combined with treatment and deterrence, hard core impaired drivers must be identified and dealt with before we as a society can move beyond this deadly crime. The Ontario Provincial Police, R.I.D.E. program does not presume to be the answer to the issue of drinking and driving. Wherever alcohol is provided the answer is only of moderation and abstinence. Friends don't let friends drink and drive. Don't be one of those "bloody idiots."

Bird count sees rise in number of species

The 43rd annual Christmas Bird Count in the Carleton Place and Almonte area, held Monday, Dec. 27 found record high numbers of seven species of birds.

The count was one of about 1,700 counts taking place over the Christmas period as part of the 94th annual Audubon Christmas Bird Count, which is designed to help survey the wintering birds of Canada, USA, Central America and the Caribbean. The local count is sponsored by the Mississippi Valley Field Naturalists.

In our area 27 field observers took part, counting birds from cars and on foot from 8 a.m. until 4 p.m. in a 15-mile diameter circle centred on the bridge in Carleton Place. As well, 52 feeder watchers counted birds at their backyard feeders. The day was very cold (-29c to -20c), which kept most watchers in their cars, but there was no wind.

The number of species recorded this year rose to 40 from 37 last year, which is about average but much below the 1984 record of 50. However, the total number of birds seen was high at 8780, slightly below the 1987 record count of 8854. The high number of birds counted was due to the record high numbers of Snow Buntings and Common Redpolls in our area this winter.

Record high numbers were also seen of Cardinals and House Finches (both southern birds extending their range northward) as well as Mallards, Red-tailed Hawks and Blue Jays. Some unexpected birds included a ring-necked Duck and a Hooded Merganser on the river in Carleton Place.

One observer was lucky enough to see a Snowy Owl, the first on the count since 1977.

The complete list of species and their counts is as follows:

Canada Goose, 2
Mallard, 20
Ring-necked Duck, 1
Common Goldeneye, 7
Hooded Merganser, 1
Common Merganser, 11
Sharp-shinned Hawk, 3
Red-tailed Hawk, 13
Rough-legged Hawk, 1
Gray Partridge, 4
Ruffed Grouse, 6
Rock Dove, 342
Mourning Dove, 159
Snowy Owl, 1
Downy Woodpecker, 72
Hairy Woodpecker, 77
Pileated Woodpecker, 3
Blue Jay, 506
American Crow, 287
Common Raven, 3
Black-capped Chickadee, 864
White-breasted Nuthatch, 78
Brown Creeper, 3
American Robin, 2
Bohemian Waxwing, 587
Northern Shrike, 3
European Starling, 103
Northern Cardinal, 54
American Tree Sparrow, 106
White-crowned Sparrow, 1
Dark-eyed Junco, 14
Snow Bunting, 2609
Pine Grosbeak, 45
Purple Finch, 7
House Finch, 118
Common Redpoll, 1535
Pine Siskin, 8
American Goldfinch, 148
Evening Grosbeak, 584
House Sparrow, 392
At the end of the day many of the participants gathered at the Mill of Kintail to see the results come in and have a snack.
The count was organized by Roy Vontobel and the results were compiled by Mike Jacques.
Georgina Doe organized the feeder counts, and the food was provided by the Mississippi Valley Field Naturalists.

Surprise 75th Birthday
Open House
for H. Frank Hamilton
SUNDAY, JANUARY 9th
2 - 4 p.m.



ALMONTE UNITED CHURCH HALL
Elgin St.
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To Our Hero **PATRICK PROULX**
for saving two damsels in distress.

The compassion and bravery you
showed during our rescue was
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SALE

SAT., JAN. 8 9:30 a.m.

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Sincere thanks to the following local merchants and organizations who generously donated these prizes to the 1993 G. L. Comba Raffle. The draw was held on December 22nd and the winners are:

Grand Prize — \$500.00 Cash — Mona Jackson, Quebec; \$100.00 Gift Certificate, Pike's Y.I.G. — Sharon Hogg, Almonte; Dinner for 2, J.R.'s Restaurant — Nathan Skjaveland, Blakeney; Sunday Brunch for 4, The Leather Works — Anne Robitaille, Kanata; Senators vs Islanders Tickets (2) — Dick Shouldice, Carleton Place; Aladdin, Heritage Video — Mrs. Roy McNeely, Carleton Place; Once Upon A Forest, Heritage Video — Donna Janveau; Centrepointe Theatre Tickets, Family of 4 — Charlie Lunn; Fresh Xmas Centre Piece, Keepsakes — Barry Connolly; Homemade Gingerbread House — Brenda's Creative Cakes — Mr. J. Pilon, Ottawa.

Bill of Rights passes third reading

People in Ontario will have a greater say in environmental decisions affecting their lives and their communities under the Environmental Bill of Rights which received third reading in the Ontario legislature in early December.

The bill ensures increased government accountability for the environment and greater protection for employees who "blow the whistle" on polluting employers.

"The Environmental Bill of Rights is landmark legislation giving Ontarians new rights and powers," said Environment and Energy Minister Bud Wildman. "The new law will effectively serve the needs of public, environmental groups, industry and government as well as the best interests of the environment."

The bill will also provide for:

- an electronic registry where the public will have access to information;
- increased public participation in environmental decision-making by government;
- increased access to the courts for Ontario residents to protect the environment;
- increased government accountability for its decisions about the environment.

"The Environmental Bill of Rights has been a priority of this government since we first took office in 1990," Wildman said. "We have developed legislation, based on extensive consultation, that will work strongly and effectively on behalf of the people of Ontario so they can accept and exercise responsibility for their environment."

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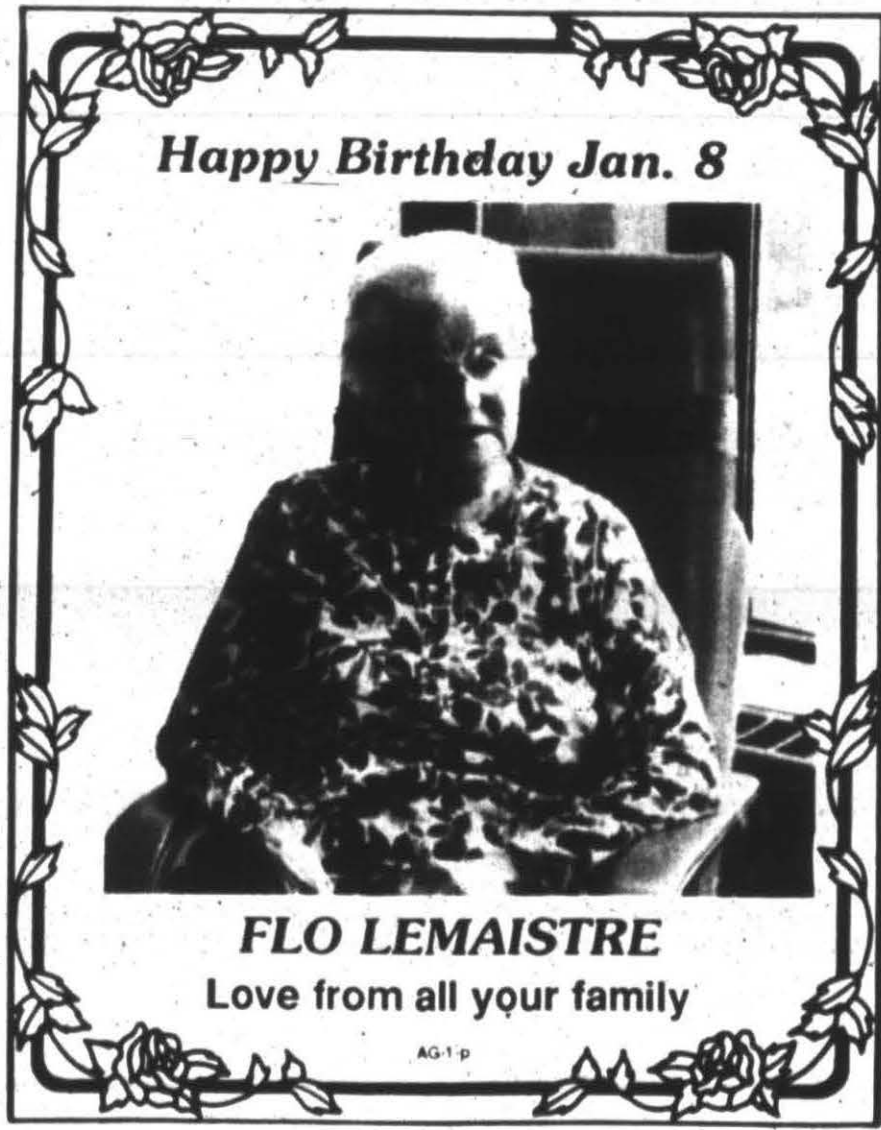
I would like to take this opportunity to thank all those people in St. Michael's and St. Peter Celestine Parishes who gave of their time, energy, and generosity in making the Christmas Liturgies a tremendous success. In particular, I wish to thank Ed Chartrand, Marg McIntyre, Cathy Ford and Rick Larock who gave of their musical talents to enhance our celebrations. As well, the choir members, altar servers, eucharistic ministers, lectors, ushers, children's liturgy organizers, and sacristans were the main reasons why the liturgies were so inspiring. Congratulations to all those people of the parish who donated food for both the Youville Centre and the West Carleton food drive. 1994 marks the International Year of the Family and our parish communities hope to mark this special year with a focus toward building up the family of St. Michael's and St. Peter Celestine.

Thank You to all those parishioners who remembered me in a special way with cards and gifts. Happy New Year to all of you!!

Father Bill



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OPEN HOUSES

SUN., JAN. 9, 1994
3:15 - 4:30 p.m.
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MINUTES TO ALMONTE — Immaculate 4 bedroom home nestled on manicured 2.8 acre lot. Bright spacious foyer, country styled maple kitchen, large family or games room. Formal living room with charming fireplace. BCP/A/625 \$149,500.

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1-3 p.m.
212 FRANKTOWN ROAD
COSY 2 STOREY — 2 bedroom home on double lot. Sep. dining room, tons of potential for the first time buyer or builder. Huge lot 130 x 208. Vendor will take back mortgage with 10% down for 3 years. BCP/F/470 \$89,900.

1 BEDROOM APT. — sunny large dining room, private parking. Available February 1. \$425.00 plus utilities, no pets. Ms. Couch 253-0518.

LARGE GRACIOUS 2 BEDROOM APT. — Hardwood floors. Available Feb. 1st. \$595.00 plus utilities. No pets. Suitable for single non smoking professional. Ms. Couch 253-0518.

THREE BEDROOM SPLIT-LEVEL — Large combined living/dining room, 2 baths, bright lower level family room. Fenced back yard with above ground swimming pool. BCP/F/827 \$114,900.

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